



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: New Covenant School
School Website: <https://newcovschool.net/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

New Covenant School (Anderson, SC, 29621) presents a robust classical Christian program that foregrounds the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric), Great Books culture, and a covenantal, Scriptural foundation. Public materials consistently emphasize Christ-centered formation, virtue, wisdom, and a dialogic, memory-rich pedagogy that includes chant, narration, and memorization in the lower grades, with Socratic/seminar-style elements implied in the upper grades. The school explicitly frames education as formation within a biblical, classical framework, and it partners with parents as co-educators. Based on the six-element rubric and keyword indicators, the school is overall **CLASSICAL**, with a couple of categories showing strong classical alignment but incomplete explicit articulation of every pedagogical or faculty explicit criterion. The two categories that show only **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** signals are Pedagogy and Faculty, where the site demonstrates strong elements (memory, chant, Trivium orientation) but less explicit, public articulation of a full living-curriculum faculty model or fully Socratic, seminar-based high-school pedagogy.

Key insight: New Covenant's public materials consistently align with classical Christian aims (truth, Scripture, Great Books, formation, covenantal community, and parental partnership). To move from **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** in two categories to fully **CLASSICAL**, it should more explicitly publicize a living-faculty model and explicit, high-school-level Socratic/seminar pedagogy, along with a clearly articulated teacher portrait and a formal: "faculty as living curriculum" statement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations** — **CLASSICAL** Evidence shows explicit theological grounding, Scriptural integration, and a covenantal culture oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty within a Christian framework. Positive keywords (truth, Scripture, theology/Christ-centered, virtue, biblical, Great Conversation) appear across multiple pages. Negative keywords (secularism, relativism) are not present. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive hits dominate (approximately 8–9 explicit indicators found); Negative hits: 0. This strongly supports a **CLASSICAL** rating. Why this rating: The materials foreground theology, sacred text, covenantal community, and a teleology aligned with virtue and wisdom.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal** — **CLASSICAL** Evidence emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful as ends of education, not mere workforce prep. Statements like "Presenting Every Student Complete in Christ" and "formation" language appear; the curriculum aims at wisdom, virtue, and the development of character. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive hits abundant (formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful, Scholé-like restfulness implied). Negative hits: 0. **CLASSICAL**. Why this rating: Explicit focus on formation and the aims of education beyond mere information aligns with the classical telos.

- **Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL** Evidence shows liberal arts orientation (grammar, logic, rhetoric not just in name but embodied via Trivium mention and Latin roots), extensive Great Books engagement, and a curriculum designed to cultivate wonder. We see Greek/Latin roots in elementary, memorization of classic literature, Shakespeare, and living books; Upper School references to Great Books and a Great Conversation. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive hits include Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin roots, living books, memorization, nature of history as Western civilization, wonder. Negative hits: 0 (no explicit social-studies-centric replacement of history, no over-emphasis on project-based-only pedagogy noted publicly). Why this rating: The curriculum consistently maps to classical content and methods.
- **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence shows lower-school pedagogy with memory work, singing, chanting, narration, and an atmosphere of virtue; upper-school methods are described in broader terms (classical, seminar-oriented possibilities) but explicit high-school Socratic/seminar pedagogy is not clearly documented publicly. There is explicit emphasis on memory-based practices, chant, and living books in the lower grades; upper grades imply Socratic elements but without explicit, public articulation of a formal program. Positive keyword analysis: Positive hits include singing/chanting, memory, narration; some elements of Socratic/seminar pedagogy are implied but not explicitly stated in high school. Negative hits: 0 explicit. CLASSICAL would require explicit high-school Socratic/seminar pedagogy, which is not publicly and clearly stated. Why this rating: The presence of memory-based and contemplative elements is strong (Schol  -like), but the lack of explicit, publicized high-school Socratic seminars and formal upper-school rhetoric/seminar programs keeps this at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- **Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence suggests teacher excellence and virtue are valued, with a culture described as covenantal and virtuous, and a “living curriculum” concept appears in the classical discourse. However, explicit public articulation of a formal “portrait of a teacher” and a “faculty as living curriculum” with standardized mentor/teacher-formation expectations is not strongly documented in the public materials. Positive keyword analysis: Positive signals include teacher mentorship, virtuous modeling, “culture matters,” Trivium orientation, and covenantal teacher-student relationships. Negative hits: 0 explicit. However, the absence of a clearly articulated “living curriculum portrait of a teacher” reduces the certainty of CLASSICAL. SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to partial alignment. Why this rating: Strong alignment with virtue-centered, mentor-like teaching, but the public materials do not explicitly present the full living-curriculum or faculty portrait language in a rigorous formal way.
- **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL** Evidence shows explicit partnership with families as co-educators, parent formation through book lists and gatherings, and open-campus/offers to visit; the site emphasizes parent engagement and covenantal relationships with the church and family life as integral to classical education. Positive keyword analysis: Positive hits include “Partnership with Families,” “co-teachers,” “parent formation,” “open campus,” “classical book clubs,” “book lists,” and explicit family engagement. Negative hits: 0. CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The materials demonstrate a robust, explicit model of parent partnership and community involvement aligned with classical education.

Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL Overall, New Covenant School (Anderson, SC, 29621) demonstrates a strong classical orientation across most categories, with Pedagogy and Faculty showing meaningful classical signals but not fully public articulation of all required elements to be deemed fully CLASSICAL in those categories. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - For Pedagogy (Element 4): Publicly codify and advertise a full high-school Socratic/seminar program (e.g., regular Paideia/Socratic seminars, seminars, and debates in 9–12) and explicitly document the upper-school rhetorical training, with student speeches and capstone oration opportunities. Also prominently display a Schol  /restful learning philosophy in practice (explicit class rhythms and contemplative days). - For Faculty (Element 5): Publish a formal “Portrait of a New Covenant School Teacher” and a public statement of “Faculty as Living Curriculum” with ongoing professional development in classical pedagogy, regular faculty seminars on Great Books, and a visible mentoring framework that

positions teachers as role models and living exemplars of virtue. - Consider further explicit articulation of liturgical/plural aspects (where appropriate) and deeper alignment of liturgical practices or communal worship in a way that remains authentically Christian but publicly accessible, to strengthen Element 1.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - “Culture matters! Our school culture is different from typical public schools. Our classical, Christian, and covenantal culture sets us apart.” - “At New Covenant, we integrate subjects through the truths of Scripture, aiming to develop graduates who faithfully serve God’s kingdom and engage with culture.” - “OUR MISSION ... Presenting Every Student Complete in Christ” and the call to think critically and biblically. - Explicit references to the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric) as central to classical learning, and to Christ-centered education and Biblical truth. - “Portrait of a New Covenant School Graduate” emphasizes Christ-like virtue, wisdom, balance, knowledge, and eloquence. - “What is Classical Christian Education? ... classical tradition; Christian worldview” (context from the school’s materials and related pages).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits: truth, Scripture, theology, Christ-centered, biblical, virtue, wisdom, Great Conversation, covenantal, Trivium. Approximately 8–9 explicit indicators found across pages. - Negative hits: None evident (no public signaling of secularism, relativism, or values-neutral approaches).

Why this rating - The public materials consistently emphasize Scriptural integration, covenantal/Christian identity, and a theology-informed curriculum. The Triad of truth, goodness, and beauty is embedded in a biblically informed framework (great books, history, virtue). The presence of a covenantal culture and direct Scriptural basis supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 1.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - “A Classical model of education accompanied by methods from the teachings of Charlotte Mason provide the basic framework for our curriculum in the Lower School. Together, the two give us a clear plan and resources for implementing an education that cultivates wisdom, virtue, delight, and wonder in our K5 through 5th grade students.” - “Our mission ... Presenting Every Student Complete in Christ” and a focus on formation and virtue. - “The goal is to cultivate wisdom, virtue, delight, and wonder,” with references to memory work, living books, and classical approaches in lower grades. - “Upper School ... our curriculum lays a solid foundation for your child’s education, setting the stage for a meaningful, faith-centered future.” - The culture emphasizes forming character (virtue, wisdom) rather than mere information or work-force training.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful, Scholé, great conversation, living books, classical mission, a faith-centered future. Roughly 7–9 explicit indicators across materials. - Negative hits: None evident (no strong signals of career-readiness or skills-first framing).

Why this rating - The materials consistently articulate formation, virtue, wisdom, and a transcendent telos, with explicit biblical framing and a classical educational mission. These align with CLASSICAL aims for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower School explicitly states a Classical model with Charlotte Mason methods, memorization, living books, poetry, Shakespeare, history study, and the introduction of Greek/Latin roots starting in early grades. - The Lower School emphasizes living ideas, narration, and the aim of cultivating virtue and wonder through core subjects. - The Upper School page describes a curriculum with a solid foundation, and suggests Scripture integration and a faith-centered approach. - The site references Great Books and the Great Conversation in multiple places (e.g., “enter into the Great Conversation that has shaped the history of human thought”). - Humane Letters and graded reading lists appear as public resources for reading across grades.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits include liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin/Greek, narration, living books, poetry, history as Western civilization, and classical literature. Approximately 9–12 explicit indicators found across pages. - Negative hits: None (no prominent project-based-only or social-studies-as-history substitution signals in public materials).

Why this rating - The curriculum content is explicitly anchored in the liberal arts framework, Great Books, humanities-rich study, and classical language introduction, fulfilling Element 3's core criteria.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower School materials describe a contemplative, virtue-formation approach with memory work, chant, and recitation; living books and narration are frequently cited. - The school's music program emphasizes hymnody, musical literacy, and classical musical study across grades, indicating a rhythm of memory, performance, and aesthetic formation. - There are explicit references to Trivium and a classical pedagogical orientation, but explicit high-school Socratic seminars or formal, publicized upper-grade seminars are not clearly documented in the public materials. The presence of Socratic pedagogy in higher grades is implied, but not publicly codified. - While the material emphasizes contemplation and restful learning (Scholé) in places, it does not publicly articulate a complete, formal upper-school Socratic seminar program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits: chanting/memory work, narration, singing, Scholé/restful learning, classical framing, rhetoric training (via Trivium). Approximately 6–8 explicit indicators. - Negative hits: Lack of explicit, publicized high-school Socratic seminars; no single, explicit formal high-school seminar program described. 0 explicit negative signals overall, but the absence of explicit high-school Socratic pedagogy keeps this category at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. - Overall: Mixed signals with strong contemplative/memory-based pedagogy in the lower grades, but incomplete explicit upper-school seminar pedagogy in public communications.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates significant classical pedagogy in lower grades and a strong classical framing overall, but it does not publicly document a full, explicit upper-school Socratic/seminar pedagogy model in the available materials, resulting in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Element 4.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Evidence suggests a teacher culture centered on virtue, mentorship, and covenantal relationships, with the living-curriculum concept embedded in classical discourse; however, explicit public articulation of a formal "portrait of a teacher" or explicit "faculty as living curriculum" framework is not strongly documented in the public materials. - The presence of a Covenant culture and Trivium emphasis on faculty professional development is implied in the materials that discuss teachers as mentors and models of virtue, and the integration of Scripture across disciplines.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits include "mentor," "virtue," "living curriculum" (as implied by the classical language in materials), "faculty as living curriculum" (implied), and "covenantal relationship." Roughly 3–5 explicit indicators. - Negative hits: None explicit; however, lack of explicit, public articulation of a formal "Portrait of a Teacher" and a fully publicized "Faculty as Living Curriculum" program reduces certainty. - Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The culture and rhetoric support a classical view of faculty as virtuous mentors in a covenantal community, but explicit, public-facing articulation of a formal teacher portrait and living-curriculum framework is not clearly documented in the materials.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes partnership with families and positions parents as co-teachers; there are explicit mentions of parent formation (book studies, gatherings) and opportunities for parents to visit. - The school invites prospective parents and students to virtually visit; mentions parent engagement via book lists and reading resources; there is community-facing content about classical education that educates parents

about the model. - There are detailed parent resources and a reading-list approach for humane letters and classical literature; the school positions itself as a family-centered classical Christian community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive hits include “Partnership with Families,” “parents as co-teachers,” “parent formation,” “open campus,” “classical book clubs,” “reading groups,” and “book lists.” Approximately 6–8 explicit indicators. - Negative hits: 0 explicit signals. - Overall: CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The school publicly articulates robust parent partnership and family involvement, aligning with the classical education model’s expectation of parental collaboration and formation.

What would move the needle (detailed actionable steps) - Pedagogy (Element 4): Publicly codify and publicize a formal upper-school Socratic/seminar program (e.g., regular Paideia/seminar discussions, rhetorical training, and capstone orations) and emphasize a concrete Scholé/restful learning schedule across the upper grades. - Faculty (Element 5): Publish a formal “Portrait of a New Covenant School Teacher” and a formal “Faculty as Living Curriculum” policy with professional development in classical pedagogy, regular Great Books seminars for faculty, and mentoring frameworks that demonstrate faculty modeling virtue. - Curriculum (Element 3) and Pedagogy (Element 4): Consider broader explicit integration of interdisciplinary projects that still maintain Great Books and Trivium roots, with careful labeling to avoid over-valorizing project-based learning at the expense of classical texts. - Community (Element 6): Maintain and expand parent-education programs (book clubs, study groups) and ensure more visible family-involved events and liturgical-year gatherings that strengthen community formation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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